

Fog of War — UI Specification (for designers)

Companion documents: **UI-DESIGN-BRIEF** (visual direction, deliverables, phases — ask Max for the translated summary of any section) and **ui-wireframes.html** (low-fi wireframes of every screen in this spec). This document describes the *interface flow*: every screen, what it shows, and what the player can do there. It reflects a working build — most screens already exist functionally (programmer-UI) and screenshots can be provided on request.

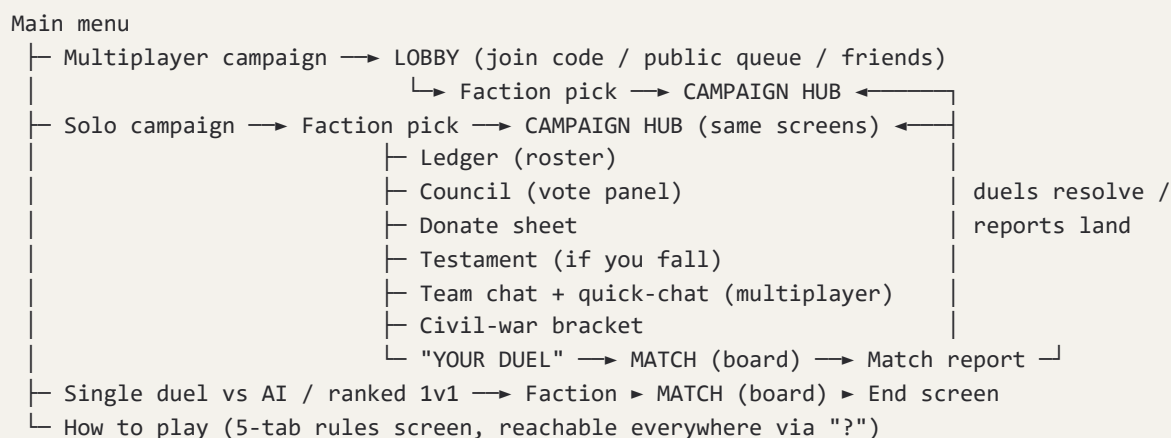
0. The game in three sentences

A 2-player turn-based strategy board game (Godot, mobile-first portrait 1080×1920) with animal soldiers in a Napoleonic setting. Players secretly define stat cards each round, assign them to pawns, and fight on an 11×11 board; first to get 2 pawns into the enemy harbor (or wipe the enemy out) wins. Around the duels sits a **campaign**: two teams of 8 players, a council that nominates fighters, donations, testaments of fallen players, and a final civil war between the surviving teammates.

The MULTIPLAYER campaign is the main focus of this product and of the design. Two teams of 8 *human* players play a social campaign (live evening sessions or async over days) — think "Among Us energy": a shared timeline, voting, backstabbing testaments, team chat. The solo campaign (vs 15 bots) uses the *same screens*; design every campaign screen multiplayer-first, with solo as the degenerate case (bots fill the seats, no chat pressure). Concretely that means: every waiting moment shows *who* we are waiting for, every action of another player lands as a feed card, and deadlines/timers are always visible (they are server-driven).

Visual direction (summary): hand-crafted early-19th-century military — aged parchment, ink, wax seals, brass; engraving-style; muted earthy palette; red vs blue team accents; icons over text; **no fantasy glow, no glossy TCG look.**

1. Screen map & flow



Push notifications (multiplayer) deep-link into: your duel ► Match setup · council open ► Council panel · new report ► the feed card · testament ► Testament panel.

Match flow (inside a duel): Placement → [per cycle: Spawn → 3× (Define cards → Reveal → Link) → Action phase] → End.

2. Screens

2.1 Main menu

- **Shows:** game title/emblem, buttons: **Multiplayer campaign** (primary) / Solo campaign / Single duel / How to play / Settings.
- **Actions:** navigate. — *Design: a "field table" feel; this is the storefront of the style.*

2.2 Faction pick (campaign start; also used for single duels)

- **Shows:** 6 faction cards — emblem, name (Pig/Mouse/Lion/Bear/Wolf/Crocodile), army composition (infantry/cavalry/artillery counts), cards-per-round × stat budget, one "pro" and one "con" line.
- **Actions:** tap a faction → confirmed permanently for the whole campaign.
- **States:** none (choice is final; a confirm affordance is welcome).

2.3 Campaign hub (the campaign's home screen)

- **Shows, top to bottom:**
 - Header: round number + phase name (Council / Donations / Duels / Testament / CIVIL WAR).
 - Your balances: soldiers · cavalry · cannons (reinforcements) · CP (command points) · points.
 - Two team columns (your team blue, enemy red): per player a portrait chip + name + balances; dead players greyed; currently-fighting players highlighted.
 - **Timeline feed** (the heart of the screen): cards for everything that happens — battle reports, donations, votes, nominations, testaments, bot chatter ("barks"), phase banners. Tapping a battle report opens the full Match report.
 - Phase panel (bottom): context panel that swaps per phase — see 2.4–2.7. While bots play, it shows live progress ("Bots are fighting duel 3 of 8: Nora vs Bruno...").
- **Actions:** open Ledger; tap feed cards; act in the phase panel; start YOUR duel.
- **7 feed-card types to design:** battle report, nomination, vote result, donation, testament, bark/quick-chat, phase banner.

2.4 Council panel (phase panel variant)

- **Shows:** the ballot ("Your team nominates: pick the fighters"), two pickers (own fighter × enemy fighter), live vote status of teammates.
- **Actions:** pick pair → vote. Closes early on unanimity. Round 1 is drawn by lot (no council).

2.5 Donate panel (phase panel variant)

- **Shows:** teammate picker, steppers for soldiers/cavalry/cannons/CP, cap hints (max 10 pawns / 3 CP per recipient per round).
- **Actions:** donate (repeatable) · "Done donating".

2.6 Testament panel (phase panel variant — the drama moment)

- **Shows:** "You have fallen." Recipient picker (any living player, including enemies!), what half of your estate amounts to, a prominent timer.
- **Actions:** bequeath half to one player · burn everything. (Timeout = everything burns.)

2.7 Your-duel panel (phase panel variant)

- **Shows:** "YOUR DUEL: you vs . Your whole estate goes to the board — losses are gone, savings carry over."
- **Actions:** "Play the duel" → switches to the Match screen.

2.8 Ledger (roster screen)

- **Shows:** sortable table of all 16 players: portrait, faction emblem, soldiers/cavalry/cannons, CP, points, alive/dead. Your row highlighted. Regiment-book styling.
- **Actions:** sort by column; back.

2.9 Civil-war bracket

- **Shows:** tournament bracket of the surviving team: seeds, pairs, byes, results.
- **Actions:** view only (duels start via the phase panel).

2.10 Match report

- **Shows:** winner + win-method icon (harbor 🏰 / elimination 💀 / tiebreak / resign), cycles fought, losses per unit type per player, CP changes, reinforcements committed.
- **Actions:** close; (later: watch replay).

2.11 MATCH — the board (the biggest screen, many sub-states)

- **Layout:** 3D board fills the screen; 2D HUD overlays.
- **HUD top bar:** phase name + cycle/round counters, whose turn (color), countdown timer.
- **Board sub-states:**
- **Placement:** drag/tap unit types onto your two home rows; ghost preview; undo; "default setup" button.
- **Spawn (campaign only):** reserve counts per type; place up to 3 reinforcements on your back row; blind & simultaneous ("opponent is choosing too...").
- **Define cards:** card fan at the bottom (see 2.12), CP-bet stepper, confirm.
- **Reveal:** both card sets side by side, initiative bid percentage, "X starts".

- **Link:** tap a card → eligible pawns highlight → tap a pawn. Alternating turns.
- **Action phase:** tap own pawn → target markers: green = move (with step cost), red = melee/charge, orange = shoot (line of fire), cyan = free wolf-step. Cannon shows an "action pot" badge. Context button for touch actions (skip/undo).
- **Premove (chess-style):** during the opponent's turn you can already queue your next action — it shows as a pinned "ghost" order on the board (pawn + target marker + small pin/seal icon) and executes the instant your turn starts, *unless* it became invalid (target died, path blocked) — then the pin dissolves with subtle feedback ("order lapsed"). One premove at a time; tap again to cancel/replace. Needs a distinct visual state: queued ≠ executed.
- **Stat chips** float above active pawns: HP (green) / stamina (blue) / attack (orange); hidden enemy stats show a "?" **seal** — never zeros (information leak).
- **End states:** win (harbor / elimination) / loss / draw-by-cycle-limit / resign / forfeit.
- **Actions:** everything above + resign (in pause/help menu) + "?" help button.

2.12 The cards

Fully specified in CARD-DESIGN-BRIEF (separate document): field-order style stat cards, 5 states (editable / revealed / selectable / linked / card back), red & blue variants, CP-bet stamp.

2.13 How to play

5 tabs (The game / Turns / Units / Fighting / Factions) — restyle of an existing text screen; illustrated examples preferred over text walls.

2.14 Settings

Sound, screen-shake toggle, notifications, language (NL/EN planned). Small screen, low priority.

2b. Multiplayer-campaign screens (MAIN FOCUS)

These make the campaign a *social* game. Solo reuses everything; these elements simply stay empty or bot-driven there.

2b.1 Lobby

- **Shows:** three entry paths — big join-code input (5 characters), "Quick play" (public queue, aims for a live 8-player evening), "With friends" (create private lobby + shareable code). While filling: seat list (8 portrait slots per team) with joined players; empty seats fill with bots after a wait, **always visibly labeled** 🤖 (trust rule: humans must instantly see who's a bot).
- **Actions:** join/create/leave; ready-up; host starts.
- **States:** filling / ready / starting.

2b.2 Team chat screen + quick-chat

- **Placement:** the bottom zone of the hub is a **two-tab area: [PHASE] [CHAT]** — the chat is a full screen state at the phase panel's position, not just an overlay. The chat tab shows an **unread badge**; while an action is required of you, the Phase tab pulses/marks so chat never hides your duty.
- **Chat screen shows:** team-only thread (portrait + message rows; bot barks share the same visual language), the sealed/ghost state for dead players, and the **quick-chat bar** pinned at the bottom: ~12 fixed phrases as icon+short-text chips ("Send me ✕", "Donate to X", "Trust me", "Traitor!") — the default communication, translatable, moderation-safe. Free text is a lobby setting (input field only when enabled).
- **Actions:** switch tabs; send quick-chat (1 tap); free text if enabled; tap a message's portrait → player detail (ledger row).
- **Design note:** the quick-chat bar also appears in compact form on the Phase tab (1 row), so you can react without leaving the ballot/donation panel.

2b.3 Waiting & connection states (every blind/simultaneous moment)

- "Waiting for X, Y..." with portrait chips + a deadline bar (server-driven) — on: card define, spawn, placement, reveal-ack, council votes, donations.
- Reconnect: "connection lost — reconnecting (grace 0:20)" banner; opponent-disconnected state in a duel ("X dropped — forfeit in 0:20").
- Deadline consequence is always pre-announced ("no choice = default loadout").

2b.4 Ghost mode (dead players)

- Dead players keep watching: entire hub in a muted/sepia "ghost" treatment, 🦇 badge on own portrait, team secrets visibly sealed ("sealed for the dead" — no team chat, no vote details), public info stays. Drama is the product: ghosts must *want* to keep watching.

2b.5 Push-notification landings

- 3 notification types (your duel ✕ / council open 🗳️ / new report 📄): each needs an icon + a one-line template, and the target screen must look correct when opened *cold* from the notification (esp. Testament with its timer already running).

3. Priorities for the first package

1. Design system: palette, 2 fonts, panel/button styles (9-patch friendly).
2. Icon set (~28 monochrome icons, readable at 24×24) + 6 faction emblems.
3. **Multiplayer campaign hub:** the 7 feed-card types + team columns + quick-chat bar + waiting/deadline states (2b.2–2b.3) — this is the product's living room.
4. Card frame + 5 states (CARD-DESIGN-BRIEF).
5. Match HUD (top bar, stat chips, target markers, "?" seal).
6. Lobby + ghost mode + notification templates.

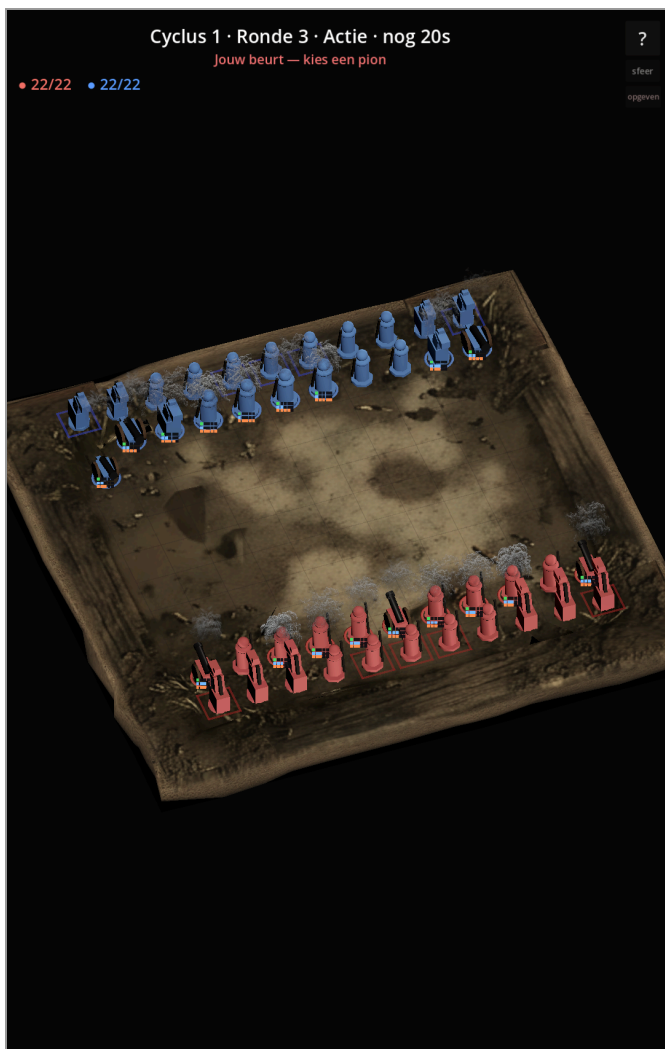
Then: remaining campaign panels → menus/help → leaderboards/profile (later phase).

4. Practical

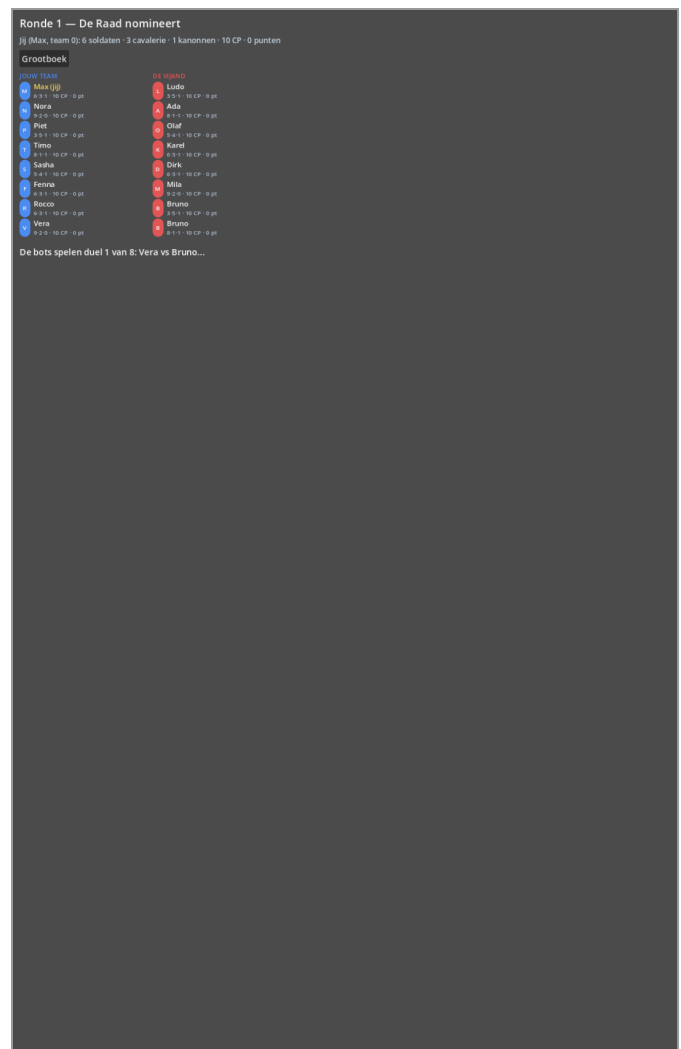
- Target: portrait 1080×1920, must stay readable on 6" phones; thumb-reachable actions.
- Deliverables: PNG with alpha or SVG; 9-patch-friendly frames; no hover-dependent interactions.
- Never leak information through design: hidden = "?" seal, never empty/zero values.
- All states must differ by shape/icon as well as color (color-blindness).

Appendix — screenshots of the current build

The game is playable today with programmer-UI; these show real layouts and content density. Everything visual is up for redesign.



The board — action phase (current build)



Campaign hub with timeline feed (programmer-UI)

GROOTBOEK — de campagne-boekhouding

sluiten

De boekhouding is openbaar: elke donatie, elk verlies en elk testament staat erin. Tik een kolom om te sorteren.

Naam	Team	Status	Sold.	Cav.	Kan.	Totaal	CP	Partners v
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Ledger / roster

Cyclus 1 · Ronde 1 · Definitie · nog 20s

Definieer je kaarten (3x budget 7) — HP = leven · Speed = stappen/acties · Aanval = schade

22/22

22/22

?

sfeer

opgeven

Kaart 1

HP — 3 +

STAMINA — 2 +

AANVAL — 2 +

Kaart 2

HP — 3 +

STAMINA — 2 +

AANVAL — 2 +

Kaart 3

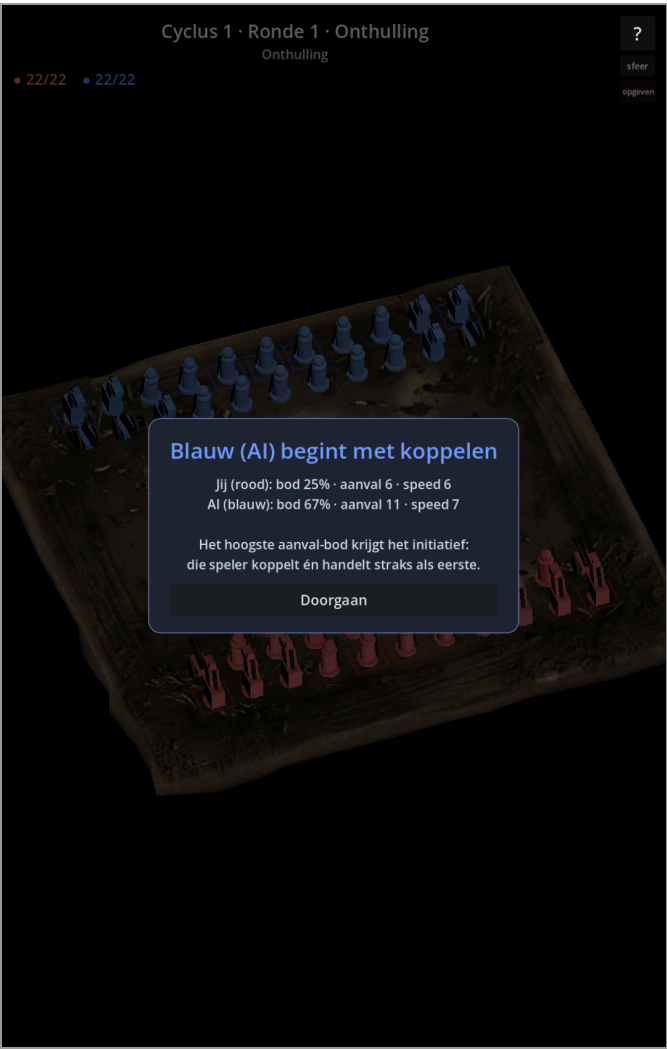
HP — 3 +

STAMINA — 2 +

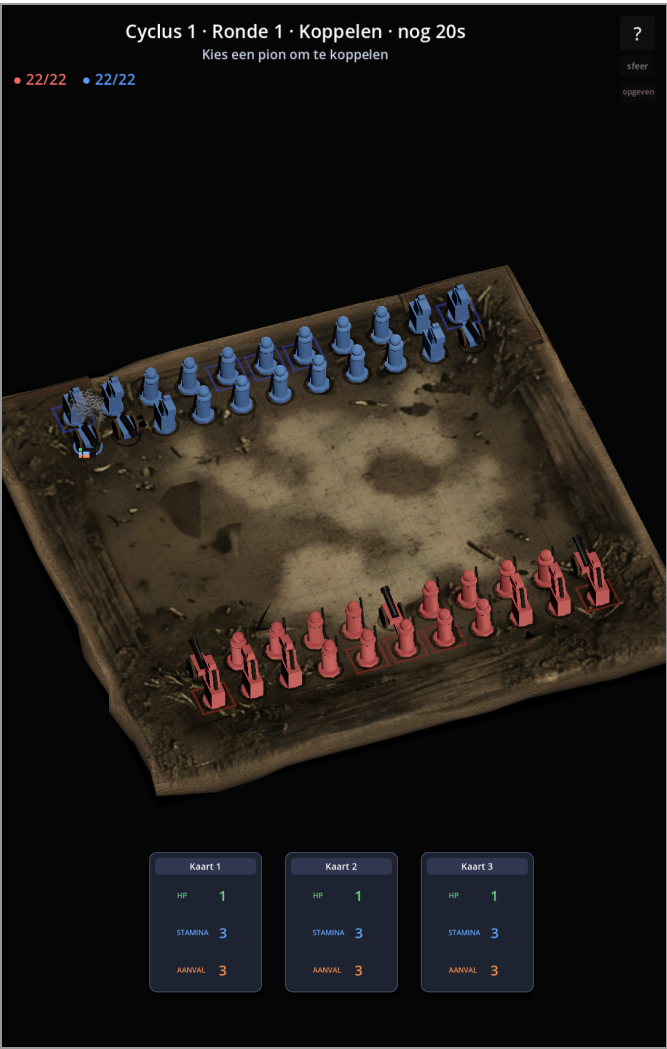
AANVAL — 2 +

Bevestigen

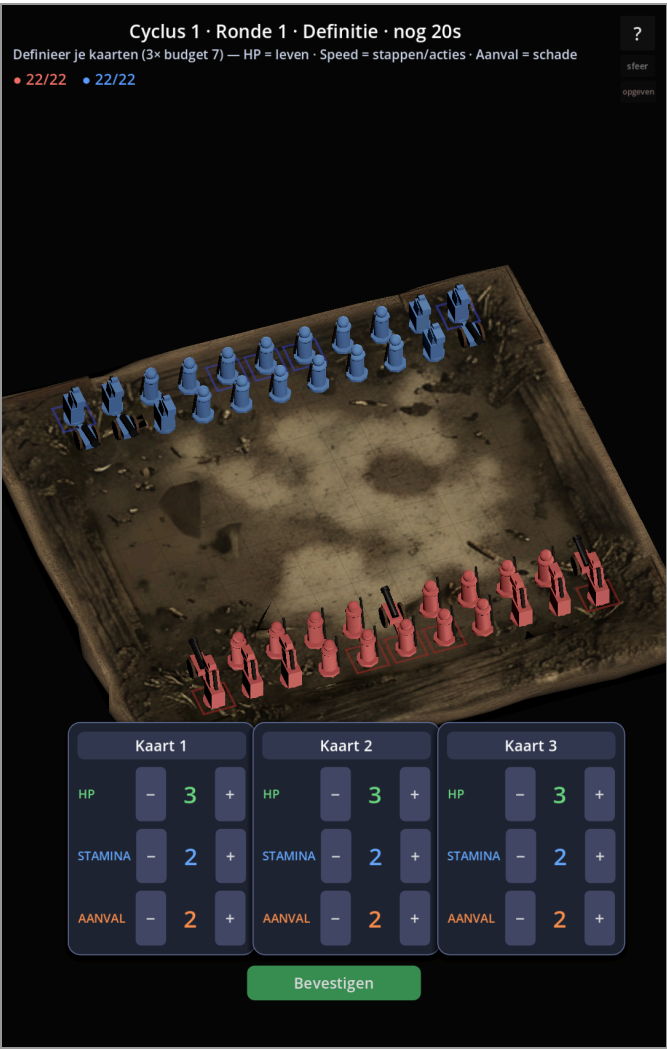
Define cards — card fan



Reveal — both card sets + initiative bid



Linking cards to pawns



Free placement on home rows



Hidden info — the "?" state (Crocodile)